

Cover letters

A cover letter is a formal letter written to accompany a résumé for a job application. It should be laid out like any formal letter, and include certain details that will promote the application. A good cover letter should be concise and no more than one page long.

The applicant's details go at the top right.

Joe Elf
Hollow Tree
Snowy Forest
North Pole

September 15, 2013

The date needs to be included under the applicant's address.

The employer's details go at the top left.

Mr. Santa Claus
Toy Workshop
Secret Mountain
North Pole

The first paragraph should state which role the applicant is applying for, and where he or she saw the vacancy.

Dear Mr. Claus,

I would like to apply for the position of Junior Toymaker advertised in the *North Pole Chronicle*. As requested, I have enclosed my résumé and two references.

The role would be an excellent opportunity for me to start my career in toy manufacturing. I believe that my internship experience and degree from the Toy College would make me an asset to the company.

The middle of the letter needs to explain why the applicant wants the job, and what skills and experience he or she has.

I can be contacted at the address and phone number on my résumé. I am available for interview next week.

Ending with a positive phrase will show enthusiasm.

I look forward to discussing this role with you soon.

Yours truly,

Joe Elf

Joe Elf